

First Terminal Examination - 2079

Class: XII

Subject: C. English (0041)

Full Marks: 75

Time: 3 hrs.

SET 'A'

Pass Marks: 30

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

Attempt all the questions.

1. Read the text and do the tasks.

Overpopulation, climate change, mass migration, farming issues, and the use of natural resources are all affecting our relationship with terra firma, and it has never been more complicated. It is increasingly looking like Earth's land is being overlooked rather than valued as a precious resource.

For those living in Malé, the overcrowded capital of the Maldives, there is no choice but to build upwards. Caged by the sea, they have no more land to spread onto, yet the city's population has soared by nearly 52% since 2006. The last census in 2014 counted 158,000 people crammed into the city's 5.7 sq km of space, and officials say the figure has since grown further.

Space is such a premium in Malé that pavements are often less than one meter wide, forcing pedestrians to walk in single file, while many streets have no sidewalk at all.

Malé, the capital of the Maldives, is emblematic of modern-day land issues: A small, increasingly urbanizing space with a skyrocketing population. Rents have risen exorbitantly and, in some of the poorest areas, up to 40 people can be squeezed into buildings with just 23.2 sq meters of space - about the same size as a small studio flat.

With so many people living under each other's feet, crime, drugs, and domestic violence have risen alarmingly while the city frequently runs out of water. An entirely new island has risen next door out of the sea itself simply from the city's garbage.

In the early 1990s, the tallest buildings in the city were only two stories high, whereas now the average height is eight stories and some are as high as 25 stories high. People are coming here because this is where health, education, and jobs are, but overpopulation is leading to many socioeconomic problems.

Although extreme, Malé is an example in miniature of something that is happening on a far larger scale around the world. With 83 million more people appearing on the planet every year, rising populations are placing increasing pressure on the land.

The UN's latest estimates state that 7.6 billion people are jostling for space on Earth at present and that number will rise to 9.8 billion by 2050. By the end of the century, their projections say there could be 11.2 billion people on our planet.

With 83 million more people appearing on the planet every year, rising populations are placing increasing pressure on the land. Each of those people will need somewhere to live, a place to work, and fertile land to provide them with food. They will need water and energy to stay warm or light their way at night. They will want roads to drive on and places to park. For the lucky ones, there will be space for their pastimes and leisure activities.

At first, it can be easy to dismiss fears that mankind may one day run out of space as ridiculous. Physically, the land can easily accommodate 11 billion people - there are around a 51.7million sq miles of ice-free land on the planet.

But large tracts of land remain virtually uninhabitable due to their climate or their remote location: Enormous tracts of Siberia are too inhospitable to be lived upon, and the huge landmass at the center of Australia is too arid to support many people, meaning the majority of its population is clustered along its coastline.

The cities and towns we live in account for less than 3% of the Earth's total land area, but between 35% and 40% is used for agriculture. As populations grow, many fear that more land will be used up to grow more food. And land

management has a lot to do with resource management – what eat, how we grow it, and how we eat it.

To feed the world's growing population, a study by researchers at Stanford University estimated that between 10,400-18,900 sq miles of additional land will be required and that there is a reserve of 1.7 million sq miles thought to be suitable for growing crops left in the world.

The researchers predicted that increasing demand for food, biofuels, industrial forestry, and the spread of urbanization will result in this reserve of land being completely used up by 2050.

The bad news is that the demand for new cropland and pastures for animals is already thought to have caused 80% of the deforestation taking place around the world today, wiping out large areas of rich biodiversity and trees that act as natural sinks for greenhouse gases.

The way we use land right now is extremely inefficient, so much of our land is being used to grow food for livestock - 75% of the world's agricultural land is used for feeding animals that we then eat ourselves. About 40% of the food grown in the world is also never eaten by anybody - it is thrown away.

A: Choose the best option

(5×1 = 5)

1. The height of most city buildings is now measured to be at a general level of
 - A. 25-storeys
 - B. 2-storeys
 - C. 8-storeys
 - D. 40-storeys
2. The estimated spare land available that is considered to be good for agricultural use, such as the growing of vegetables is
 - A. 51.7m sq miles
 - B. 1.7m sq miles
 - C. 10,000 sq miles
 - D. 18,900 sq miles

3. The current population figure produced by the United Nations for our planet is an estimated
 - A. 11.2 billion
 - B. 11 billion
 - C. 7.6 billion
 - D. 9.8 billion
4.% of the Earth's total land area is covered by cities and towns.
 - A. Less than 17
 - B. Less than 3
 - C. Less than 40
 - D. Less than 13
5. The percentage figure for the food we humans grow on Earth that is discarded as waste is approximately
 - A. 75%
 - B. 3%
 - C. 52%
 - D. 40%

B. Decide whether the given sentences are *TRUE*, *FALSE*, or *NOT GIVEN*.

(5×1 = 5)

1. From 2006 onwards, the rate of city dwellers in the Maldivian capital has grown by just under 50%.
2. Walking single file is common on the pavement due to crowding.
3. Water shortages are an almost everyday occurrence in the city mentioned.
4. Large portions of the land on Earth are completely unsuited for human occupation.
5. The researchers denied that increasing demand for food, biofuels, and industrial forestry may lead to a complete reserve of land by half the 21st century.

C. Complete the following sentences with *NO MORE THAN FOUR WORDS*

(5×1=5)

1. Almost 52 million sq km of land is available to handle the more than 11 billion projected population as it is classified as being

2. Whereas cities account for less than 5% of land usage, just over a third of the land available on Earth is used for
3. The loss of vast expanses of healthy forests that act naturally to absorb
4. A brand new piece of man-made land has been formed beside the current city, jumping out from the sea itself, made solely by using unwanted
5. The bad news is that the demand for new cropland and pastures for animals is already thought to have caused 80% of thetaking place around the world today.

2. Write short answers to the following questions. (5×2 = 10)

- a. Analyze the use of the metaphorical device(s) in this stanza:

I'll tell you how the sun rose,

A ribbon at a time.

The steeples swam in amethyst,

The news like squirrels ran. (A Day)

- b. *A Matter of Husbands* sheds light on the basic function of actors: to make the audience believe in an illusion.' How do you explain this statement?
- c. Why do you think the speaker is praying to God, but not to a scientist or any other? Discuss the poem, *Every Morning When I Wake*, as a prayer to God.
- d. How do you evaluate marriage as a social institution depicted by the essayist and marriage in our society? Do you think marriage has a similar role to play in our present Nepalese society as well? Why or why not? (*Marriage as a Social Institution*)
- e. As a part of the setting, the writer significantly mentions the changes coming in seasons in *Neighbours*. What is the significance of this change in the story?

3. **Write long answers to the following questions.** (2×5 = 10)
- "I was not a good pupil, but I was a good learner." Explain this statement concerning the essay, *On Libraries*.
 - The narrator says that 'besides being a respectable woman she was a very sensible one, and she knew there are some battles in life which a human being must fight alone.' What is the significance of this statement? How does this statement justify the writer's depiction of modern sensibility in the story, *A Respectable Woman*?
4. **Suppose you are the General Manager of Nepal Airlines. Issue a press release on behalf of the airlines about the cancellation of all the domestic booking flights from October 6-7 due to some technical reasons. 150 words** (7)
5. **As our society is heading ahead, we have witnessed some changes in the family structure. Write an email to your friend mentioning the impacts they will bring on society and the importance of family in about 180 words.** (8)
6. **When people succeed, it is entirely because of hard work. Luck has nothing to do with their success. Do you agree or disagree with the following statement? Use specific reasons and examples to explain your position. Write your essay in about 300 words** (10)
7. **Do as indicated in the brackets and rewrite the sentences.** (10×1 = 10)
- What a shame,? (Tag Question)
 - Goodbye,? (Tag Question)
 - Everythingfine when it's done correctly. (Choose the best option: will work/ works/worked)
 - Killingnot always considered a bad thing. (Choose the best option: were/was/would)
 - There are plenty of tomatoes in the fridge. You..... buy any. (Choose the best modal verb: needn't /shouldn't /mustn't)
 - They didn't want to come with us at first, but wepersuade them. Drivers. (Choose the best modal verb: could/ couldn't / managed to)

- g. 'The bus was late this morning.' 'How long? (you/wait)
(Complete the sentences using **have/has/had to..**. Also, use the verbs in brackets.)
- h. Most of the cities are polluted. Many people live in cities (Rewrite the sentences to make a sensible single sentence using: **although**)
- i. He had a leg injury. He completed the marathon. (Rewrite the sentences to make a sensible single sentence using: **in spite of**)
- j. I don't rememberabout the accident. (Choose the best option: anything /something /nothing)

8. Choose and copy the correct answer.

(5×1 = 5)

- a. I think that coverage of the fact is.....to lying really.
- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| i. freight | ii. equivalent |
| iii. levitation | iv. disparate |
- b. Jina and Ram declined to invest in the start-up and had little cause to their decision until many years later when the company they had spurned suddenly became the flavor of the day.
- | | |
|------------|--------------|
| i. Change | ii. regret |
| iii. defer | iv. abrogate |
- c. She decided to buy herself a necklace to remember her old life before she said..... to her luxurious lifestyle. (choose the best option: Bye/buy/by)
- d. Use '**plaque**' in a sensible sentence.
- e. Form two words using the prefix-**UP**

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